Question ID: bbaac300

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Geometry and Trigonometry	Right triangles and trigonometry	Easy

Question

Triangle ABC is similar to triangle DEF, where angle A corresponds to angle D, and angles C and F are right angles. If $\cos B = \frac{1}{22}$, what is the value of $\cos E$?

Answer

A. $\frac{1}{22}$

B. $\frac{1}{23}$

C. $\frac{21}{22}$

D. $\frac{22}{23}$

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is correct. The cosine of an acute angle in a right triangle is defined as the ratio of the length of the leg adjacent to that angle to the length of the hypotenuse. It's given that angle C is a right angle in triangle ABC and that angle F is a right angle in triangle DEF. Therefore, $\cos B$ is equal to the ratio of the length of side BC to the length of side AB, and $\cos E$ is equal to the ratio of the length of side EF to the length of side DE. It's also given that triangle ABC is similar to triangle DEF, where angle A corresponds to angle D. Since similar triangles have proportional side lengths, $\frac{BC}{AB} = \frac{EF}{DE}$. Therefore, the value of $\cos B$ is equal to the value of $\cos E$. Since $\cos B = \frac{1}{22}$, the value of $\cos E$ is $\frac{1}{22}$.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from conceptual errors.

Choice C is incorrect and may result from conceptual errors.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from conceptual errors.